General rule – armor and weapons: properties · "Equipment" chapter of SRD 5.2.1

An **armor** gives a **base AC**: Light (+ Dex), Medium (+ Dex, max +2), Heavy (fixed). Without armor training, you have **Disadvantage** on Strength and Dexterity d20 rolls and can't cast spells.

Each **weapon** has **properties**: Ammunition, Finesse, Heavy, Light, Loading, Reach, Thrown, Two-Handed, Versatile.

🎲 Quick summary:

1. Light armor: base AC + **Dex**.
2. Medium armor: base AC + Dex (**max +2**).
3. Heavy armor: fixed AC, Strength required.
4. Each weapon has properties that change its use.

⚠ Change from 2014

SRD 2024 adds weapon masteries and clarifies Ammunition and Loading.

⚠ Flaw in the rule and fixes Table rule

The SRD doesn't list every weapon on these sheets. Fix: check the weapon and armor tables.

💡 Narrative option: Table rule

The DM can describe the weight of heavy armor to justify the Strength requirement.

Step 1 – Calculate AC:

Light armor: base + Dex. Medium: base + Dex (max 2). Heavy: base only.

Step 2 – Check Strength:

Chain Mail (13), Splint (15), Plate (15): otherwise Speed −10 ft.

Step 3 – Stealth:

Some armors give Disadvantage on Stealth checks.

Step 4 – Read the weapon:

Finesse, Light, Heavy, Reach, Thrown, Ammunition, Loading, Two-Handed, Versatile.

Step 5 – Don / doff:

See the "Using a Shield" sheet for times.

Example: Mira wears Studded Leather (12 + Dex +3): AC 15. She wields a rapier (Finesse).

Element	Rule
Studded Leather	AC 12 + Dex
Hide	AC 12 + Dex (max 2)
Chain Shirt	AC 13 + Dex (max 2)
Chain Mail	AC 16; Str 13; Disadvantage on Stealth
Plate	AC 18; Str 15; Disadvantage on Stealth
Finesse	Use Strength or Dex for attack and damage
Light	Allows a 2nd strike with a Light weapon
Heavy	Disadvantage for Small creatures
Reach	+5 ft reach
Thrown	Can be thrown; same modifier
Ammunition	Draw ammo for each attack; recoverable
Loading	One attack per action
Versatile	Higher damage with two hands
Two-Handed	Needs two hands to attack

⚠ Common questions:

Without armor training?

Disadvantage on Str and Dex rolls, no spells.

Finesse or Strength?

Wielder's choice, for attack and damage.

Can ammo be recovered?

About half after combat.

A reach weapon?

+5 ft reach, including Opportunity Attacks.

Heavy armor and Strength?

Speed −10 ft if Strength isn't met.

Two Light weapons?

Two-weapon fighting with the Light property.

Versatile weapon?

Higher damage with two hands.

⚠ Debate points and table options: Table rule

Armor and spells

Armor without training: no spells. **Option**: keep it.

Recovering ammo

How much is recovered? **Option**: half.

Improvised weapons

No properties. **Option**: 1d4 damage.

Mount armor

Armor for mounts. **Option**: out of scope.

⚠ Rule clarifications (answers found on the web, reworded):

Medium armor

The Dex bonus is capped at +2.

Stealth

The Disadvantage applies to all Stealth checks.

Reach

It also affects Opportunity Attacks.

Ammunition

Drawing ammo is part of the attack; it's free.

These points remain open to discussion: your feedback is welcome to refine this sheet.

Notices: This work includes material from the System Reference Document 5.2.1 ("SRD 5.2.1") by Wizards of the Coast LLC, available at https://www.dndbeyond.com/srd. The SRD 5.2.1 is licensed under the Creative Commons Attribution 4.0 International License, available at https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by/4.0/legalcode. Unofficial sheet, 5E compatible (2024 rules), neither approved nor sponsored by Wizards of the Coast. Rules come from SRD 5.2.1; where the SRD gives no answer, explanations rely on our own interpretation. The "Table rule" parts are the author's own creations. Borders, banner, texture, titles, layout, table rules and examples: © Jaja, all rights reserved. Sources: SRD 5.2.1 (official English version); rule clarifications cross-checked with answers found on the web and reworded; numeric examples are invented; last revised: November 2026. Fonts: TeX Gyre Pagella (GUST), DejaVu Sans, Noto Color Emoji (OFL).